

Image Composition

Learning Objectives

- Combine multiple images into one composition
- Use cropping and resizing for proper layout
- Apply the rule of thirds for balanced design

Engage (5-7 minutes)

When you create a collage for a school project, you cut pictures from magazines, arrange them on a chart paper, and add borders and labels. Image composition in GIMP is the same process but digital—you combine photos, adjust sizes, and arrange elements for a professional result.

Explore (10-12 minutes)

Open two different images in GIMP. Select part of one image, copy it, and paste it as a new layer onto the second image. Use the Scale tool to resize the pasted image. Then try the Crop tool to trim unwanted areas. Arrange the elements so the composition looks balanced.

Explain (10-12 minutes)

Image composition combines multiple visual elements into one image. Use Copy and Paste to bring elements from one image to another. The Scale tool resizes layers proportionally. The Crop tool trims the canvas to a specific area. The rule of thirds divides the image into a 3x3 grid—place important elements along the lines or intersections for a balanced, professional look.

Elaborate (8-10 minutes)

Think of arranging items on a shop display. You place the best products at eye level, group related items, and leave space for breathing. Image composition follows the same principles—balance, spacing, and focal points. When combining a portrait with a landscape background, where would you place the person using the rule of thirds?

Evaluate (5-8 minutes)

Exit ticket: Explain the rule of thirds in your own words. Then combine two images into one composition with at least three elements. If you finish early, add text labels to complete your collage.